



ETOH Withdrawal

Assessment

Pediatric Pearls:

Signs & Symptoms:

- Headache
- Nausea and/or Vomiting
- Diarrhea
- Restlessness or sleeplessness
- Tachycardia
- Hypertension
- Tremors
- Tongue fasciculation
- Confusion and/or Agitation
- Seizures
- Cessation or temporary abstinence from alcohol use

Differential:

- Hypoglycemia
- Head trauma
- Heat exhaustion/ Heat stroke
- Drug or toxin exposure
- Sepsis
- Hypoxia
- Cardiac issues
- Seizure disorder

Clinical Management Options

P	P	P	P	P	P	• Take a thorough history to include volume, quantity, and frequency of alcohol use • Provide oxygen as needed to maintain SpO₂ > 94% • Oral hydration, if tolerated
L	L	L	L	L	L	• Vascular access • Begin fluid resuscitation with 20 ml/kg isotonic crystalloid
1	2	3	4	5	6	• If the patient meets indications for alcohol withdrawal syndrome in accordance to the screening checklist and has no exclusions, then Midazolam

Consult Online Medical Control As Needed

Alcohol Withdrawal Syndrome Screening Tool

Inclusion Criteria – All Must Be Present

1. Intact verbal communication capabilities.
2. Sudden period of cessation of alcohol consumption within the past 3 days.
3. Presenting with 3 or more of the following signs/symptoms:
 - a. Nausea or Vomiting
 - b. Tremors
 - c. Sweating
 - d. Agitation
 - e. Heart rate > 100 beats per minute
4. Eighteen (18) years of age or older

Exclusion Criteria

1. Signs and Symptoms likely due to underlying medical illness or injury.
2. Respiratory distress

Additional Considerations that Increase the Risk for Respiratory Depression

1. Opioid use
2. COPD
3. Obstructive sleep apnea

Pearls:

- Refer to drug formulary charts for all medication dosing for both adults and pediatric patients.
- Alcohol withdrawal has a high mortality rate without appropriate treatment.
- It is important to treat symptoms early rather than waiting for symptoms to become serious.
- Patients may not be initially forthcoming about their alcohol history.